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Character Matters

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Character Matters

You can identify them by their fruit, that is, by the way they act. Can you pick grapes from thorn bushes, or figs from thistles? (Matthew 7:16)

Character is the essence of who we are. Our character is comprised of the values and convictions that have been shaped by our relationships and life experiences. Character is developed over time.

Character changes usually require a great deal of time.

Every person has external and internal qualities. The external qualities are easily perceived, but the inner ones require careful observation. When the prophet Samuel was sent by God to anoint a new king of Israel to replace Saul, God cautioned him, “Don’t judge by his appearance or height, for I have rejected him. The LORD doesn’t see things the way you see them.

“There is no way to grow a saint overnight. Character, like the oak tree, does not spring up like a mushroom.” —Vance Havner

People judge by outward appearance, but the LORD looks at the heart. (1 Samuel 16:7)

God is committed to transforming you into the character likeness of Jesus.

Here are some guidelines you can review yourself to help you discern the character in others.

Words reflect the inner self.

It’s not what goes into your mouth that defiles you; you are defiled by the words that come out of your mouth. (Matthew 15:11)

Actions speak louder than words.

*A good tree can't produce bad fruit, and a bad tree can't produce good fruit.
(Luke 6:43)*

Friendships indicate standards.

Do not be misled: "Bad company corrupts good character." (1 Corinthians 15:33, NIV)

Expenditures demonstrate values.

*Wherever your treasure is, there the desires of your heart will also be.
(Matthew 6:21)*

Difficulties reveal strengths (and weaknesses) of character.

*We can rejoice, too, when we run into problems and trials, for we know that they help us develop endurance. And endurance develops strength of character.
(Romans 5:3-4)*

Character is who you really are. Whenever God reveals something in your character that he wants to change, stop and ask the Holy Spirit to help bring about the necessary transformation.